

How a fulfilment provider turned cold email into its primary growth channel

A Dutch e-commerce fulfilment and 3PL provider went from ad hoc outreach to 78 qualified opportunities and EUR 1.56M in pipeline. Here is the exact play, and how you run it.

The setup

Storage, pick and pack, shipping for fast-growing online stores. Before us: outreach was ad hoc, poorly targeted, no dedicated sending domains, no warmup, no deliverability management. Growth was capped by how many conversations they could start by hand. They wanted predictable pipeline without building an expensive in-house outbound team.

Who we target

Not every webshop. Only the ones big enough to need a real fulfilment partner and small enough to still be reachable:

- Fast-growing e-commerce in NL (and BE), selling on Bol.com, Amazon, or their own webshop (Shopify, WooCommerce, Magento)
- Max ~10 employees
- Min EUR 15K revenue per month (floor; EUR 10K as fallback)
- Max ~500 active SKUs
- Small, light products: toys, sports and outdoor, home and garden (furniture excluded), electronics, cosmetics
- Fashion is a hard no, return rates wreck the unit economics
- Buyers: owner or founder, CEO or MD, Head of Ops, E-commerce Manager, Supply Chain Manager
- Geography: NL first, BE and DE next

The play

Scrape - StoreLeads for NL webshops doing more than EUR 15K per month - Bol.com sellers - Competitor audiences: LinkedIn followers of rival fulfilment providers - All of it assembled in Clay across 100+ sources, then filtered to the ICP on sector, company size, geography, and tech stack

Enrich and qualify - Clay enrichment on every record - An AI model reads each company website in bulk and checks four things: is this real e-commerce, is the

product small and light enough for the warehouse, do they run a webshop, are they under ~500 SKUs - Phone number enriched on every opportunity, so it lands in the CRM ready to call - The qualifier model matters. A cheap model let furniture, white goods, and no-webshop leads slip through. Moving to a stronger model cleaned the list. Bad-fit leads waste sends and burn reply rate.

Send - Dedicated cold-email domains and inboxes, DKIM, SPF and DMARC set correctly, full warmup before anything goes out - Plain-text emails, no open or click tracking, both protect deliverability - Four campaigns split by product niche: Toys and Hobbies, Beauty and Cosmetics, Electronics, Sports and Outdoor - Three-step sequence, three A/B variants on the first email - Timing: email 1, then step 2 after 3 days, step 3 after 4 days. Mon to Fri, 09:00 to 17:00. The sequence stops the second someone replies. - Replies sync into the CRM. An approve or deny bot in Slack keeps reply time short.

The angle that worked

- Named-niche opener. “We fulfil for beauty webshops,” not generic logistics. The prospect sees themselves in line one.
- Service-led, soft CTA. Never price-led in the opener.
- A “free savings calculation” variant: offer to run their current fulfilment cost against ours. Concrete, low friction, gets replies without pitching price cold.
- Sender identity moves the number. Emails from the founder converted better than emails from the operations co-founder, so we routed as many sends as possible through the founder’s name.

The numbers

Metric	Result
Emails sent	~9,500
Reply rate	13.9% (industry average 5-7%)
Qualified opportunities	78
Pipeline created	EUR 1.56M
First conversations booked	within weeks of go-live

The payback

The constraint flipped fast: not “where are the leads” but “who works all these leads.” Demand came in faster than the existing team could handle, so they

hired a dedicated salesperson just to keep up with the incoming requests. Outbound went from afterthought to their primary growth channel.

Takeaway you can apply today

Narrow the list to webshops big enough to need you, revenue and SKU floors, not everyone. Split campaigns by product niche. Send from the founder's inbox with a savings-calculation offer, not a price. Precision beats volume, and it pays for itself before it needs headcount.

Want this pointed at your fulfilment pipeline? We build the whole engine: list, infrastructure, copy, campaigns, CRM. Book 30 minutes:
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